

Preferences > Memory & Image Cache), enter 75 per cent for 'Used by Photoshop'.

IMAGEREADY

Slow Display

 ImageReady can become very slow when working with large images. The program works best with only 72-dpi images. All other editing should be done with Photoshop; resize to this resolution and then work in ImageReady.

Saving a Proper PNG (for the Web)

 The Portable Network Graphics (PNG) is a remarkable image format with a ton of features—true colour 48-bit (or 16-bit greyscale), alpha channels, interlacing (progressive display), gamma correction, and lossless compression! Of course, if you have ever saved a PNG from Photoshop without correcting all the above parameters, you will not like the result.

The PNG format allows applications to write a chunk that determines what gamma correction to use to display the image properly. Photoshop 5 has a bug that incorrectly saves images with a gamma chunk that is off by a factor of exactly 2.0. Photoshop 5.5, 6 and 7 are better, but the gamma information is still incorrect. Though Photoshop doesn't make errors when actually writing the pixel data, applications that use the embedded information are misled, and will display an overly dark image.

As far as Web images go, it's better to use the



gamma = 2.2 colourspace, so that applications that ignore gamma information will display the image as their creator intended—this works because typical PC monitors have an inbuilt gamma of 2.2.

Save Transparent GIFs And PNGs

 A common misconception is that enabling the 'Transparent' option and choosing a Matte colour, from the 'Optimize' palette, will save your image with a transparency. In fact, the image should already contain a transparency, which ImageReady will display with a checkerboard pattern, in order

to utilise the 'Transparent' and 'Matte' options.

In order to save a transparent image, you must first create or save a transparent image using one of the following techniques, and then reload it into ImageReady:

Either use the 'Magic Eraser' tool ([Shift] + [E]) to erase the region(s) you wish to make transparent, or use the 'Magic Wand' tool, [W], to select the colours you wish to make transparent and then delete them.

Now, if the 'Optimize' palette is not already visible, press [F10], or choose **Window > Show > Optimize** from the menus. Select your

preferred visualisation tab, choose a default optimisation setting from the Settings combo box, and save your settings by selecting 'Save Settings' from the 'Optimize' palette menu.

Finally, save the optimised (transparent) image by pressing [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Shift] + [S] (or File > Save Optimized As). You are done!

Control Dithering

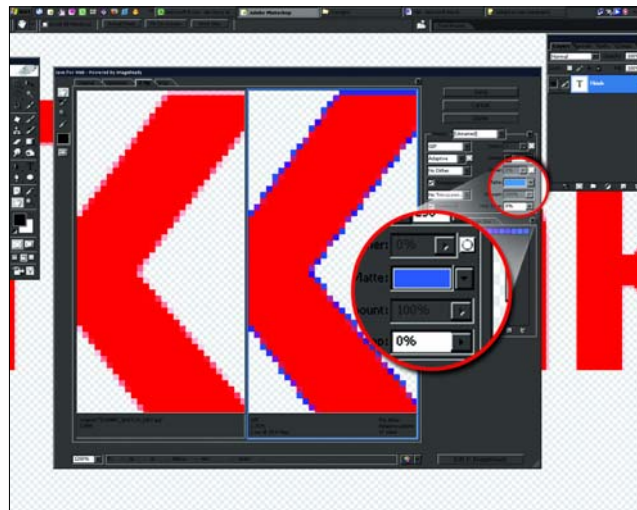
 The dither Algorithm dropdown on the 'Optimize' palette lets you choose a dithering method for the image. The 'Dither' percentage slider lets you control the range of colours simulated by dithering. A higher dithering per cent creates the appearance of more colours and more detail in an image, but can also increase the file size. For optimal compression, use the lowest percentage of application dither that provides the colour detail you require.

Lights, Camera, Action

 Use actions to automate repetitive tasks and save time. To create an Action, click on the 'Menu' arrow on the Actions palette and click on 'New Action'. Provide a name for the 'Action' and click 'Record' to start recording. Carry out the steps for the action, in the sequence that they should occur. Click on 'Stop' once you are done. To apply an Action, select it and click on the Play button on the Action palette.

Favouring Colours

 Indexing an image is tough—you play with all the settings to achieve satisfactory results, and sometimes you still can't achieve it. For example, when indexing an image with many colours, or forcing an image to use less than 256 colours, you may end up with bad dithering patterns and colours. You can use the selection tools to select or isolate problematic colours, and Photoshop will favour these colours when choosing the palette.



Set the Matte colour the same as the background colour on your Web page. This removes the halo effect around the edges of the text.

Bet You Didn't Know

Better Text Effects

When using anti-aliased text with a transparent background, set the Matte colour the same as the background colour on your Web page. This removes the halo effect around the edges of the text. To specify a Matte colour, select it from the 'Matte' dropdown on the 'Optimize' palette. You can also select either the foreground or background colours as the Matte colour from here.